

SOLVED PRACTICE WORKBOOK

Arid Desert Landforms / Thar Desertification - Solved Practice Workbook

UPSC complete learning session | Foundation to advanced | Concepts, evidence, practice and answer writing

Arid Desert Landforms / Thar Desertification	
REFRESHED TEACHING NAVIGATION — BASIC/CORE FIRST	
01 FOUNDATION — DESERT, ARIDITY, DROUGHT AND DEGRADATION Evidence chain: Concept boundary Qualified use: Open the 2020	02 FOUNDATION — WHY DESERTS FORM Evidence chain: Aridity controls Qualified use: Classify deserts by
03 FOUNDATION — WEATHERING AND SEDIMENT SUPPLY Arid weathering includes thermal, salt and episodic moisture effects.	04 FOUNDATION — CREEP, SALTATION AND SUSPENSION Evidence chain: Aeolian transport Qualified use: Use process.
05 CORE — WIND EROSION AND RESIDUAL LANDFORMS Evidence chain: Erosional landforms Qualified use: Avoid wind-only	06 CORE — DUNE TYPES AND WIND REGIMES Evidence chain: Dune anatomy Qualified use: Read dune shape as
07 CORE — WADIS, FANS, PEDIMENTS AND PLAYAS Wadis, alluvial fans, bajadas, pediments, playas and salt flats show	08 CORE — THAR REGIONAL MOSAIC Evidence chain: Thar spatial mosaic - Thar climate and ecology
09 CORE — THAR ORIGIN AND SUSCEPTIBILITY Evidence chain: Origin debate - Natural susceptibility Qualified use:	10 CORE — HUMAN ACCELERATION AND THRESHOLDS Evidence chain: Human accelerators Qualified use: Link pressure to
11 CORE — ARAVALLI ECOLOGICAL FUNCTIONS Evidence chain: Aravalli function Qualified use: Explain relief, drainage	12 CORE — INDIRA GANDHI CANAL TRADE-OFFS Evidence chain: Indira Gandhi Canal balance Qualified use: Use a
13 SYNTHESIS — PYQ BOUNDARY AND LDN Evidence chain: Desertification beyond desert - LDN logic Qualified	14 SYNTHESIS — RESTORATION AND MONITORING Evidence chain: Process-matched restoration - Monitoring discipline
15 SYNTHESIS — PYQ OWNERSHIP AND CURRENT BOUNDARY Evidence chain: Verified PYQ boundary - Current evidence boundary	

Original deterministic study visual; labels are explanatory, not textual quotations.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

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BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

Q1. Which statement correctly explains Concept boundary?

A. A desert is a climatic region, aridity a long-term moisture deficit, drought a temporary anomaly, land degradation a broad decline in condition, and desertification dryland degradation. B. Subtropical subsidence, continentality, rain shadow, cold currents and polar cold can create deserts; heat alone is neither necessary nor sufficient. C. Wind moves coarse particles mainly by surface creep, sand by saltation and fine dust by suspension; deflation removes loose material and abrasion sandblasts exposed surfaces. D. Large thermal ranges, salt crystallisation and episodic wetting weaken exposed rock, while sparse cover leaves debris available to wind and flash runoff.

Answer: A. Explanation: A desert is a climatic region, aridity a long-term moisture deficit, drought a temporary anomaly, land degradation a broad decline in condition, and desertification dryland degradation. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q2. Which option is the safest spatial interpretation of Concept boundary?

A. Wind moves coarse particles mainly by surface creep, sand by saltation and fine dust by suspension; deflation removes loose material and abrasion sandblasts exposed surfaces. B. A desert is a climatic region, aridity a long-term moisture deficit, drought a temporary anomaly, land degradation a broad decline in condition, and desertification dryland degradation. C. Large thermal ranges, salt crystallisation and episodic wetting weaken exposed rock, while sparse cover leaves debris available to wind and flash runoff. D. Deflation hollows, desert pavement, ventifacts, yardangs, zeugens, rock pedestals and inselbergs reflect different combinations of wind, structure and weathering.

Answer: B. Explanation: A desert is a climatic region, aridity a long-term moisture deficit, drought a temporary anomaly, land degradation a broad decline in condition, and desertification dryland degradation. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q3. Which statement preserves the process boundary for Concept boundary?

A. A barchan has horns pointing downwind under limited sand and one prevailing wind; transverse, longitudinal, parabolic and star dunes indicate different sand, vegetation and wind regimes. B. Deflation hollows, desert pavement, ventifacts, yardangs, zeugens, rock pedestals and inselbergs reflect different combinations of wind, structure and weathering. C. A desert is a climatic region, aridity a long-term moisture deficit, drought a temporary anomaly, land degradation a broad decline in condition, and desertification dryland degradation. D. Wind moves coarse particles mainly by surface creep, sand by saltation and fine dust by suspension; deflation removes loose material and abrasion sandblasts exposed surfaces.

Answer: C. Explanation: A desert is a climatic region, aridity a long-term moisture deficit, drought a temporary anomaly, land degradation a broad decline in condition, and desertification dryland degradation. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q4. Which option avoids the main UPSC trap concerning Concept boundary?

A. Deflation hollows, desert pavement, ventifacts, yardangs, zeugens, rock pedestals and inselbergs reflect different combinations of wind, structure and weathering. B. A barchan has horns pointing downwind under limited sand and one prevailing wind; transverse, longitudinal, parabolic and star dunes indicate different sand, vegetation and wind regimes. C. Wadis, alluvial fans, bajadas, pediments, playas and salt flats show that episodic runoff and evaporation are integral to desert geomorphology. D. A desert is a climatic region, aridity a long-term moisture deficit, drought a temporary anomaly, land degradation a broad decline in condition, and desertification dryland degradation.

Answer: D. Explanation: A desert is a climatic region, aridity a long-term moisture deficit, drought a temporary anomaly, land degradation a broad decline in condition, and desertification dryland degradation. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q5. Which statement correctly explains Aridity controls?

A. Subtropical subsidence, continentality, rain shadow, cold currents and polar cold can create deserts; heat alone is neither necessary nor sufficient. B. Large thermal ranges, salt crystallisation and episodic wetting weaken exposed rock, while sparse cover leaves debris available to wind and flash runoff. C. Deflation hollows, desert pavement, ventifacts, yardangs, zeugens, rock pedestals and inselbergs reflect different combinations of wind, structure and weathering. D. Wind moves coarse particles mainly by surface creep, sand by saltation and fine dust by suspension; deflation removes loose material and abrasion sandblasts exposed surfaces.

Answer: A. Explanation: Subtropical subsidence, continentality, rain shadow, cold currents and polar cold can create deserts; heat alone is neither necessary nor sufficient. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q6. Which option is the safest spatial interpretation of Aridity controls?

A. Wind moves coarse particles mainly by surface creep, sand by saltation and fine dust by suspension; deflation removes loose material and abrasion sandblasts exposed surfaces. B. Subtropical subsidence, continentality, rain shadow, cold currents and polar cold can create deserts; heat alone is neither necessary nor sufficient. C. A barchan has horns pointing downwind under limited sand and one prevailing wind; transverse, longitudinal, parabolic and star dunes indicate different sand, vegetation and wind regimes. D. Deflation hollows, desert pavement, ventifacts, yardangs, zeugens, rock pedestals and inselbergs reflect different combinations of wind, structure and weathering.

Answer: B. Explanation: Subtropical subsidence, continentality, rain shadow, cold currents and polar cold can create deserts; heat alone is neither necessary nor sufficient. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q7. Which statement preserves the process boundary for Aridity controls?

A. A barchan has horns pointing downwind under limited sand and one prevailing wind; transverse, longitudinal, parabolic and star dunes indicate different sand, vegetation and wind regimes. B. Wadis, alluvial fans, bajadas, pediments, playas and salt flats show that episodic runoff and evaporation are integral to desert geomorphology. C. Subtropical subsidence, continentality, rain shadow, cold currents and polar cold can create deserts; heat alone is neither necessary nor sufficient. D. Deflation hollows, desert pavement, ventifacts, yardangs, zeugens, rock pedestals and inselbergs reflect different combinations of wind, structure and weathering.

Answer: C. Explanation: Subtropical subsidence, continentality, rain shadow, cold currents and polar cold can create deserts; heat alone is neither necessary nor sufficient. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q8. Which option avoids the main UPSC trap concerning Aridity controls?

A. A barchan has horns pointing downwind under limited sand and one prevailing wind; transverse, longitudinal, parabolic and star dunes indicate different sand, vegetation and wind regimes. B. The Thar includes dune fields, interdunes, rocky residuals, pediments, alluvium, playas, settlements and canal-modified tracts; it is not one continuous erg. C. Wadis, alluvial fans, bajadas, pediments, playas and salt flats show that episodic runoff and evaporation are integral to desert geomorphology. D. Subtropical subsidence, continentality, rain shadow, cold currents and polar cold can create deserts; heat alone is neither necessary nor sufficient.

Answer: D. Explanation: Subtropical subsidence, continentality, rain shadow, cold currents and polar cold can create deserts; heat alone is neither necessary nor sufficient. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q9. Which statement correctly explains Weathering in arid lands?

A. Large thermal ranges, salt crystallisation and episodic wetting weaken exposed rock, while sparse cover leaves debris available to wind and flash runoff. B. A barchan has horns pointing downwind under limited sand and one prevailing wind; transverse, longitudinal, parabolic and star dunes indicate different sand, vegetation and wind regimes. C. Deflation hollows, desert pavement, ventifacts, yardangs, zeugens, rock pedestals and inselbergs reflect different combinations of wind, structure and weathering. D. Wind moves coarse particles mainly by surface creep, sand by saltation and fine dust by suspension; deflation removes loose material and abrasion sandblasts exposed surfaces.

Answer: A. Explanation: Large thermal ranges, salt crystallisation and episodic wetting weaken exposed rock, while sparse cover leaves debris available to wind and flash runoff. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q10. Which option is the safest spatial interpretation of Weathering in arid lands?

A. Wadis, alluvial fans, bajadas, pediments, playas and salt flats show that episodic runoff and evaporation are integral to desert geomorphology. B. Large thermal ranges, salt crystallisation and episodic wetting weaken exposed rock, while sparse cover leaves debris available to wind and flash runoff. C. Deflation hollows, desert pavement, ventifacts, yardangs, zeugens, rock pedestals and inselbergs reflect different combinations of wind, structure and weathering. D. A barchan has horns pointing downwind under limited sand and one prevailing wind; transverse, longitudinal, parabolic and star dunes indicate different sand, vegetation and wind regimes.

Answer: B. Explanation: Large thermal ranges, salt crystallisation and episodic wetting weaken exposed rock, while sparse cover leaves debris available to wind and flash runoff. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q11. Which statement preserves the process boundary for Weathering in arid lands?

A. The Thar includes dune fields, interdunes, rocky residuals, pediments, alluvium, playas, settlements and canal-modified tracts; it is not one continuous erg. B. Wadis, alluvial fans, bajadas, pediments, playas and salt flats show that episodic runoff and evaporation are integral to desert geomorphology. C. Large thermal ranges, salt crystallisation and episodic wetting weaken exposed rock, while sparse cover leaves debris available to wind and flash runoff. D. A barchan has horns pointing downwind under limited sand and one prevailing wind; transverse, longitudinal, parabolic and star dunes indicate different sand, vegetation and wind regimes.

Answer: C. Explanation: Large thermal ranges, salt crystallisation and episodic wetting weaken exposed rock, while sparse cover leaves debris available to wind and flash runoff. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q12. Which option avoids the main UPSC trap concerning Weathering in arid lands?

A. The Thar includes dune fields, interdunes, rocky residuals, pediments, alluvium, playas, settlements and canal-modified tracts; it is not one continuous erg. B. Wadis, alluvial fans, bajadas, pediments, playas and salt flats show that episodic runoff and evaporation are integral to desert geomorphology. C. Highly variable rainfall, high evaporative demand, ephemeral drainage and pulse-based productivity support drought-adapted vegetation, pastoral mobility and risk-spreading livelihoods. D. Large thermal ranges, salt crystallisation and episodic wetting weaken exposed rock, while sparse cover leaves debris available to wind and flash runoff.

Answer: D. Explanation: Large thermal ranges, salt crystallisation and episodic wetting weaken exposed rock, while sparse cover leaves debris available to wind and flash runoff. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q13. Which statement correctly explains Aeolian transport?

A. Wind moves coarse particles mainly by surface creep, sand by saltation and fine dust by suspension; deflation removes loose material and abrasion sandblasts exposed surfaces. B. Wadis, alluvial fans, bajadas, pediments, playas and salt flats show that episodic runoff and evaporation are integral to desert geomorphology. C. A barchan has horns pointing downwind under limited sand and one prevailing wind; transverse, longitudinal, parabolic and star dunes indicate different sand, vegetation and wind regimes. D. Deflation hollows, desert pavement, ventifacts, yardangs, zeugens, rock pedestals and inselbergs reflect different combinations of wind, structure and weathering.

Answer: A. Explanation: Wind moves coarse particles mainly by surface creep, sand by saltation and fine dust by suspension; deflation removes loose material and abrasion sandblasts exposed surfaces. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q14. Which option is the safest spatial interpretation of Aeolian transport?

A. Wadis, alluvial fans, bajadas, pediments, playas and salt flats show that episodic runoff and evaporation are integral to desert geomorphology. B. Wind moves coarse particles mainly by surface creep, sand by saltation and fine dust by suspension; deflation removes loose material and abrasion sandblasts exposed surfaces. C. The Thar includes dune fields, interdunes, rocky residuals, pediments, alluvium, playas, settlements and canal-modified tracts; it is not one continuous erg. D. A barchan has horns pointing downwind under limited sand and one prevailing wind; transverse, longitudinal, parabolic and star dunes indicate different sand, vegetation and wind regimes.

Answer: B. Explanation: Wind moves coarse particles mainly by surface creep, sand by saltation and fine dust by suspension; deflation removes loose material and abrasion sandblasts exposed surfaces. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q15. Which statement preserves the process boundary for Aeolian transport?

A. The Thar includes dune fields, interdunes, rocky residuals, pediments, alluvium, playas, settlements and canal-modified tracts; it is not one continuous erg. B. Wadis, alluvial fans, bajadas, pediments, playas and salt flats show that episodic runoff and evaporation are integral to desert geomorphology. C. Wind moves coarse particles mainly by surface creep, sand by saltation and fine dust by suspension; deflation removes loose material and abrasion sandblasts exposed surfaces. D. Highly variable rainfall, high evaporative demand, ephemeral drainage and pulse-based productivity support drought-adapted vegetation, pastoral mobility and risk-spreading livelihoods.

Answer: C. Explanation: Wind moves coarse particles mainly by surface creep, sand by saltation and fine dust by suspension; deflation removes loose material and abrasion sandblasts exposed surfaces. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q16. Which option avoids the main UPSC trap concerning Aeolian transport?

A. Highly variable rainfall, high evaporative demand, ephemeral drainage and pulse-based productivity support drought-adapted vegetation, pastoral mobility and risk-spreading livelihoods. B. The Thar is polygenetic: tectonic and drainage history, monsoon variability, wind reworking and human land use operated over different timescales; one-cause origin claims are unsafe. C. The Thar includes dune fields, interdunes, rocky residuals, pediments, alluvium, playas, settlements and canal-modified tracts; it is not one continuous erg. D. Wind moves coarse particles mainly by surface creep, sand by saltation and fine dust by suspension; deflation removes loose material and abrasion sandblasts exposed surfaces.

Answer: D. Explanation: Wind moves coarse particles mainly by surface creep, sand by saltation and fine dust by suspension; deflation removes loose material and abrasion sandblasts exposed surfaces. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q17. Which statement correctly explains Erosional landforms?

A. Deflation hollows, desert pavement, ventifacts, yardangs, zeugens, rock pedestals and inselbergs reflect different combinations of wind, structure and weathering. B. The Thar includes dune fields, interdunes, rocky residuals, pediments, alluvium, playas, settlements and canal-modified tracts; it is not one continuous erg. C. A barchan has horns pointing downwind under limited sand and one prevailing wind; transverse, longitudinal, parabolic and star dunes indicate different sand, vegetation and wind regimes. D. Wadis, alluvial fans, bajadas, pediments, playas and salt flats show that episodic runoff and evaporation are integral to desert geomorphology.

Answer: A. Explanation: Deflation hollows, desert pavement, ventifacts, yardangs, zeugens, rock pedestals and inselbergs reflect different combinations of wind, structure and weathering. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q18. Which option is the safest spatial interpretation of Erosional landforms?

A. The Thar includes dune fields, interdunes, rocky residuals, pediments, alluvium, playas, settlements and canal-modified tracts; it is not one continuous erg. B. Deflation hollows, desert pavement, ventifacts, yardangs, zeugens, rock pedestals and inselbergs reflect different combinations of wind, structure and weathering. C. Highly variable rainfall, high evaporative demand, ephemeral drainage and pulse-based productivity support drought-adapted vegetation, pastoral mobility and risk-spreading livelihoods. D. Wadis, alluvial fans, bajadas, pediments, playas and salt flats show that episodic runoff and evaporation are integral to desert geomorphology.

Answer: B. Explanation: Deflation hollows, desert pavement, ventifacts, yardangs, zeugens, rock pedestals and inselbergs reflect different combinations of wind, structure and weathering. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q19. Which statement preserves the process boundary for Erosional landforms?

A. Highly variable rainfall, high evaporative demand, ephemeral drainage and pulse-based productivity support drought-adapted vegetation, pastoral mobility and risk-spreading livelihoods. B. The Thar includes dune fields, interdunes, rocky residuals, pediments, alluvium, playas, settlements and canal-modified tracts; it is not one continuous erg. C. Deflation hollows, desert pavement, ventifacts, yardangs, zeugens, rock pedestals and inselbergs reflect different combinations of wind, structure and weathering. D. The Thar is polygenetic: tectonic and drainage history, monsoon variability, wind reworking and human land use operated over different timescales; one-cause origin claims are unsafe.

Answer: C. Explanation: Deflation hollows, desert pavement, ventifacts, yardangs, zeugens, rock pedestals and inselbergs reflect different combinations of wind, structure and weathering. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q20. Which option avoids the main UPSC trap concerning Erosional landforms?

A. The Thar is polygenetic: tectonic and drainage history, monsoon variability, wind reworking and human land use operated over different timescales; one-cause origin claims are unsafe. B. Highly variable rainfall, high evaporative demand, ephemeral drainage and pulse-based productivity support drought-adapted vegetation, pastoral mobility and risk-spreading livelihoods. C. Low and variable rainfall, erodible sediment, strong winds, saline basins and slow biological recovery create susceptibility without proving degradation. D. Deflation hollows, desert pavement, ventifacts, yardangs, zeugens, rock pedestals and inselbergs reflect different combinations of wind, structure and weathering.

Answer: D. Explanation: Deflation hollows, desert pavement, ventifacts, yardangs, zeugens, rock pedestals and inselbergs reflect different combinations of wind, structure and weathering. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q21. Which statement correctly explains Dune anatomy?

A. A barchan has horns pointing downwind under limited sand and one prevailing wind; transverse, longitudinal, parabolic and star dunes indicate different sand, vegetation and wind regimes. B. The Thar includes dune fields, interdunes, rocky residuals, pediments, alluvium, playas, settlements and canal-modified tracts; it is not one continuous erg. C. Wadis, alluvial fans, bajadas, pediments, playas and salt flats show that episodic runoff and evaporation are integral to desert geomorphology. D. Highly variable rainfall, high evaporative demand, ephemeral drainage and pulse-based productivity support drought-adapted vegetation, pastoral mobility and risk-spreading livelihoods.

Answer: A. Explanation: A barchan has horns pointing downwind under limited sand and one prevailing wind; transverse, longitudinal, parabolic and star dunes indicate different sand, vegetation and wind regimes. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q22. Which option is the safest spatial interpretation of Dune anatomy?

A. The Thar is polygenetic: tectonic and drainage history, monsoon variability, wind reworking and human land use operated over different timescales; one-cause origin claims are unsafe. B. A barchan has horns pointing downwind under limited sand and one prevailing wind; transverse, longitudinal, parabolic and star dunes indicate different sand, vegetation and wind regimes. C. Highly variable rainfall, high evaporative demand, ephemeral drainage and pulse-based productivity support drought-adapted vegetation, pastoral mobility and risk-spreading livelihoods. D. The Thar includes dune fields, interdunes, rocky residuals, pediments, alluvium, playas, settlements and canal-modified tracts; it is not one continuous erg.

Answer: B. Explanation: A barchan has horns pointing downwind under limited sand and one prevailing wind; transverse, longitudinal, parabolic and star dunes indicate different sand, vegetation and wind regimes. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q23. Which statement preserves the process boundary for Dune anatomy?

A. The Thar is polygenetic: tectonic and drainage history, monsoon variability, wind reworking and human land use operated over different timescales; one-cause origin claims are unsafe. B. Low and variable rainfall, erodible sediment, strong winds, saline basins and slow biological recovery create susceptibility without proving degradation. C. A barchan has horns pointing downwind under limited sand and one prevailing wind; transverse, longitudinal, parabolic and star dunes indicate different sand, vegetation and wind regimes. D. Highly variable rainfall, high evaporative demand, ephemeral drainage and pulse-based productivity support drought-adapted vegetation, pastoral mobility and risk-spreading livelihoods.

Answer: C. Explanation: A barchan has horns pointing downwind under limited sand and one prevailing wind; transverse, longitudinal, parabolic and star dunes indicate different sand, vegetation and wind regimes. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q24. Which option avoids the main UPSC trap concerning Dune anatomy?

A. Low and variable rainfall, erodible sediment, strong winds, saline basins and slow biological recovery create susceptibility without proving degradation. B. Vegetation removal, poorly managed grazing, repeated tillage, groundwater stress, mining, infrastructure fragmentation and unsuitable irrigation can exceed recovery thresholds. C. The Thar is polygenetic: tectonic and drainage history, monsoon variability, wind reworking and human land use operated over different timescales; one-cause origin claims are unsafe. D. A barchan has horns pointing downwind under limited sand and one prevailing wind; transverse, longitudinal, parabolic and star dunes indicate different sand, vegetation and wind regimes.

Answer: D. Explanation: A barchan has horns pointing downwind under limited sand and one prevailing wind; transverse, longitudinal, parabolic and star dunes indicate different sand, vegetation and wind regimes. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q25. Which statement correctly explains Water-built desert forms?

A. Wadis, alluvial fans, bajadas, pediments, playas and salt flats show that episodic runoff and evaporation are integral to desert geomorphology. B. The Thar is polygenetic: tectonic and drainage history, monsoon variability, wind reworking and human land use operated over different timescales; one-cause origin claims are unsafe. C. Highly variable rainfall, high evaporative demand, ephemeral drainage and pulse-based productivity support drought-adapted vegetation, pastoral mobility and risk-spreading livelihoods. D. The Thar includes dune fields, interdunes, rocky residuals, pediments, alluvium, playas, settlements and canal-modified tracts; it is not one continuous erg.

Answer: A. Explanation: Wadis, alluvial fans, bajadas, pediments, playas and salt flats show that episodic runoff and evaporation are integral to desert geomorphology. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q26. Which option is the safest spatial interpretation of Water-built desert forms?

A. The Thar is polygenetic: tectonic and drainage history, monsoon variability, wind reworking and human land use operated over different timescales; one-cause origin claims are unsafe. B. Wadis, alluvial fans, bajadas, pediments, playas and salt flats show that episodic runoff and evaporation are integral to desert geomorphology. C. Highly variable rainfall, high evaporative demand, ephemeral drainage and pulse-based productivity support drought-adapted vegetation, pastoral mobility and risk-spreading livelihoods. D. Low and variable rainfall, erodible sediment, strong winds, saline basins and slow biological recovery create susceptibility without proving degradation.

Answer: B. Explanation: Wadis, alluvial fans, bajadas, pediments, playas and salt flats show that episodic runoff and evaporation are integral to desert geomorphology. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q27. Which statement preserves the process boundary for Water-built desert forms?

A. Vegetation removal, poorly managed grazing, repeated tillage, groundwater stress, mining, infrastructure fragmentation and unsuitable irrigation can exceed recovery thresholds. B. Low and variable rainfall, erodible sediment, strong winds, saline basins and slow biological recovery create susceptibility without proving degradation. C. Wadis, alluvial fans, bajadas, pediments, playas and salt flats show that episodic runoff and evaporation are integral to desert geomorphology. D. The Thar is polygenetic: tectonic and drainage history, monsoon variability, wind reworking and human land use operated over different timescales; one-cause origin claims are unsafe.

Answer: C. Explanation: Wadis, alluvial fans, bajadas, pediments, playas and salt flats show that episodic runoff and evaporation are integral to desert geomorphology. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q28. Which option avoids the main UPSC trap concerning Water-built desert forms?

A. Low and variable rainfall, erodible sediment, strong winds, saline basins and slow biological recovery create susceptibility without proving degradation. B. Vegetation removal, poorly managed grazing, repeated tillage, groundwater stress, mining, infrastructure fragmentation and unsuitable irrigation can exceed recovery thresholds. C. The Aravalli influences relief, drainage, habitat connectivity and local erosion control, but it is not a complete wall that mechanically blocks all desert movement. D. Wadis, alluvial fans, bajadas, pediments, playas and salt flats show that episodic runoff and evaporation are integral to desert geomorphology.

Answer: D. Explanation: Wadis, alluvial fans, bajadas, pediments, playas and salt flats show that episodic runoff and evaporation are integral to desert geomorphology. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q29. Which statement correctly explains Thar spatial mosaic?

A. The Thar includes dune fields, interdunes, rocky residuals, pediments, alluvium, playas, settlements and canal-modified tracts; it is not one continuous erg. B. Highly variable rainfall, high evaporative demand, ephemeral drainage and pulse-based productivity support drought-adapted vegetation, pastoral mobility and risk-spreading livelihoods. C. The Thar is polygenetic: tectonic and drainage history, monsoon variability, wind reworking and human land use operated over different timescales; one-cause origin claims are unsafe. D. Low and variable rainfall, erodible sediment, strong winds, saline basins and slow biological recovery create susceptibility without proving degradation.

Answer: A. Explanation: The Thar includes dune fields, interdunes, rocky residuals, pediments, alluvium, playas, settlements and canal-modified tracts; it is not one continuous erg. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q30. Which option is the safest spatial interpretation of Thar spatial mosaic?

A. The Thar is polygenetic: tectonic and drainage history, monsoon variability, wind reworking and human land use operated over different timescales; one-cause origin claims are unsafe. B. The Thar includes dune fields, interdunes, rocky residuals, pediments, alluvium, playas, settlements and canal-modified tracts; it is not one continuous erg. C. Low and variable rainfall, erodible sediment, strong winds, saline basins and slow biological recovery create susceptibility without proving degradation. D. Vegetation removal, poorly managed grazing, repeated tillage, groundwater stress, mining, infrastructure fragmentation and unsuitable irrigation can exceed recovery thresholds.

Answer: B. Explanation: The Thar includes dune fields, interdunes, rocky residuals, pediments, alluvium, playas, settlements and canal-modified tracts; it is not one continuous erg. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q31. Which statement preserves the process boundary for Thar spatial mosaic?

A. Vegetation removal, poorly managed grazing, repeated tillage, groundwater stress, mining, infrastructure fragmentation and unsuitable irrigation can exceed recovery thresholds. B. The Aravalli influences relief, drainage, habitat connectivity and local erosion control, but it is not a complete wall that mechanically blocks all desert movement. C. The Thar includes dune fields, interdunes, rocky residuals, pediments, alluvium, playas, settlements and canal-modified tracts; it is not one continuous erg. D. Low and variable rainfall, erodible sediment, strong winds, saline basins and slow biological recovery create susceptibility without proving degradation.

Answer: C. Explanation: The Thar includes dune fields, interdunes, rocky residuals, pediments, alluvium, playas, settlements and canal-modified tracts; it is not one continuous erg. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q32. Which option avoids the main UPSC trap concerning Thar spatial mosaic?

A. Canal irrigation can support farming, water supply and settlement while seepage, waterlogging, salinity, invasive spread and crop-water mismatch create new risks where drainage is weak. B. Vegetation removal, poorly managed grazing, repeated tillage, groundwater stress, mining, infrastructure fragmentation and unsuitable irrigation can exceed recovery thresholds. C. The Aravalli influences relief, drainage, habitat connectivity and local erosion control, but it is not a complete wall that mechanically blocks all desert movement. D. The Thar includes dune fields, interdunes, rocky residuals, pediments, alluvium, playas, settlements and canal-modified tracts; it is not one continuous erg.

Answer: D. Explanation: The Thar includes dune fields, interdunes, rocky residuals, pediments, alluvium, playas, settlements and canal-modified tracts; it is not one continuous erg. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q33. Which statement correctly explains Thar climate and ecology?

A. Highly variable rainfall, high evaporative demand, ephemeral drainage and pulse-based productivity support drought-adapted vegetation, pastoral mobility and risk-spreading livelihoods. B. The Thar is polygenetic: tectonic and drainage history, monsoon variability, wind reworking and human land use operated over different timescales; one-cause origin claims are unsafe. C. Low and variable rainfall, erodible sediment, strong winds, saline basins and slow biological recovery create susceptibility without proving degradation. D. Vegetation removal, poorly managed grazing, repeated tillage, groundwater stress, mining, infrastructure fragmentation and unsuitable irrigation can exceed recovery thresholds.

Answer: A. Explanation: Highly variable rainfall, high evaporative demand, ephemeral drainage and pulse-based productivity support drought-adapted vegetation, pastoral mobility and risk-spreading livelihoods. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q34. Which option is the safest spatial interpretation of Thar climate and ecology?

A. Low and variable rainfall, erodible sediment, strong winds, saline basins and slow biological recovery create susceptibility without proving degradation. B. Highly variable rainfall, high evaporative demand, ephemeral drainage and pulse-based productivity support drought-adapted vegetation, pastoral mobility and risk-spreading livelihoods. C. The Aravalli influences relief, drainage, habitat connectivity and local erosion control, but it is not a complete wall that mechanically blocks all desert movement. D. Vegetation removal, poorly managed grazing, repeated tillage, groundwater stress, mining, infrastructure fragmentation and unsuitable irrigation can exceed recovery thresholds.

Answer: B. Explanation: Highly variable rainfall, high evaporative demand, ephemeral drainage and pulse-based productivity support drought-adapted vegetation, pastoral mobility and risk-spreading livelihoods. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q35. Which statement preserves the process boundary for Thar climate and ecology?

A. The Aravalli influences relief, drainage, habitat connectivity and local erosion control, but it is not a complete wall that mechanically blocks all desert movement. B. Vegetation removal, poorly managed grazing, repeated tillage, groundwater stress, mining, infrastructure fragmentation and unsuitable irrigation can exceed recovery thresholds. C. Highly variable rainfall, high evaporative demand, ephemeral drainage and pulse-based productivity support drought-adapted vegetation, pastoral mobility and risk-spreading livelihoods. D. Canal irrigation can support farming, water supply and settlement while seepage, waterlogging, salinity, invasive spread and crop-water mismatch create new risks where drainage is weak.

Answer: C. Explanation: Highly variable rainfall, high evaporative demand, ephemeral drainage and pulse-based productivity support drought-adapted vegetation, pastoral mobility and risk-spreading livelihoods. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q36. Which option avoids the main UPSC trap concerning Thar climate and ecology?

A. The 2020 GS-I wording invites examples beyond visible deserts, but strict UNCCD usage confines desertification to arid, semi-arid and dry sub-humid lands; humid cases are broader land degradation. B. Canal irrigation can support farming, water supply and settlement while seepage, waterlogging, salinity, invasive spread and crop-water mismatch create new risks where drainage is weak. C. The Aravalli influences relief, drainage, habitat connectivity and local erosion control, but it is not a complete wall that mechanically blocks all desert movement. D. Highly variable rainfall, high evaporative demand, ephemeral drainage and pulse-based productivity support drought-adapted vegetation, pastoral mobility and risk-spreading livelihoods.

Answer: D. Explanation: Highly variable rainfall, high evaporative demand, ephemeral drainage and pulse-based productivity support drought-adapted vegetation, pastoral mobility and risk-spreading livelihoods. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q37. Which statement correctly explains Origin debate?

A. The Thar is polygenetic: tectonic and drainage history, monsoon variability, wind reworking and human land use operated over different timescales; one-cause origin claims are unsafe. B. Vegetation removal, poorly managed grazing, repeated tillage, groundwater stress, mining, infrastructure fragmentation and unsuitable irrigation can exceed recovery thresholds. C. Low and variable rainfall, erodible sediment, strong winds, saline basins and slow biological recovery create susceptibility without proving degradation. D. The Aravalli influences relief, drainage, habitat connectivity and local erosion control, but it is not a complete wall that mechanically blocks all desert movement.

Answer: A. Explanation: The Thar is polygenetic: tectonic and drainage history, monsoon variability, wind reworking and human land use operated over different timescales; one-cause origin claims are unsafe. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q38. Which option is the safest spatial interpretation of Origin debate?

A. The Aravalli influences relief, drainage, habitat connectivity and local erosion control, but it is not a complete wall that mechanically blocks all desert movement. B. The Thar is polygenetic: tectonic and drainage history, monsoon variability, wind reworking and human land use operated over different timescales; one-cause origin claims are unsafe. C. Canal irrigation can support farming, water supply and settlement while seepage, waterlogging, salinity, invasive spread and crop-water mismatch create new risks where drainage is weak. D. Vegetation removal, poorly managed grazing, repeated tillage, groundwater stress, mining, infrastructure fragmentation and unsuitable irrigation can exceed recovery thresholds.

Answer: B. Explanation: The Thar is polygenetic: tectonic and drainage history, monsoon variability, wind reworking and human land use operated over different timescales; one-cause origin claims are unsafe. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q39. Which statement preserves the process boundary for Origin debate?

A. The 2020 GS-I wording invites examples beyond visible deserts, but strict UNCCD usage confines desertification to arid, semi-arid and dry sub-humid lands; humid cases are broader land degradation. B. Canal irrigation can support farming, water supply and settlement while seepage, waterlogging, salinity, invasive spread and crop-water mismatch create new risks where drainage is weak. C. The Thar is polygenetic: tectonic and drainage history, monsoon variability, wind reworking and human land use operated over different timescales; one-cause origin claims are unsafe. D. The Aravalli influences relief, drainage, habitat connectivity and local erosion control, but it is not a complete wall that mechanically blocks all desert movement.

Answer: C. Explanation: The Thar is polygenetic: tectonic and drainage history, monsoon variability, wind reworking and human land use operated over different timescales; one-cause origin claims are unsafe. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q40. Which option avoids the main UPSC trap concerning Origin debate?

A. Land Degradation Neutrality seeks to balance anticipated losses with measures that avoid, reduce and reverse degradation while protecting land-based natural capital. B. Canal irrigation can support farming, water supply and settlement while seepage, waterlogging, salinity, invasive spread and crop-water mismatch create new risks where drainage is weak. C. The 2020 GS-I wording invites examples beyond visible deserts, but strict UNCCD usage confines desertification to arid, semi-arid and dry sub-humid lands; humid cases are broader land degradation. D. The Thar is polygenetic: tectonic and drainage history, monsoon variability, wind reworking and human land use operated over different timescales; one-cause origin claims are unsafe.

Answer: D. Explanation: The Thar is polygenetic: tectonic and drainage history, monsoon variability, wind reworking and human land use operated over different timescales; one-cause origin claims are unsafe. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q41. Which statement correctly explains Natural susceptibility?

A. Low and variable rainfall, erodible sediment, strong winds, saline basins and slow biological recovery create susceptibility without proving degradation. B. Vegetation removal, poorly managed grazing, repeated tillage, groundwater stress, mining, infrastructure fragmentation and unsuitable irrigation can exceed recovery thresholds. C. The Aravalli influences relief, drainage, habitat connectivity and local erosion control, but it is not a complete wall that mechanically blocks all desert movement. D. Canal irrigation can support farming, water supply and settlement while seepage, waterlogging, salinity, invasive spread and crop-water mismatch create new risks where drainage is weak.

Answer: A. Explanation: Low and variable rainfall, erodible sediment, strong winds, saline basins and slow biological recovery create susceptibility without proving degradation. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q42. Which option is the safest spatial interpretation of Natural susceptibility?

A. The Aravalli influences relief, drainage, habitat connectivity and local erosion control, but it is not a complete wall that mechanically blocks all desert movement. B. Low and variable rainfall, erodible sediment, strong winds, saline basins and slow biological recovery create susceptibility without proving degradation. C. Canal irrigation can support farming, water supply and settlement while seepage, waterlogging, salinity, invasive spread and crop-water mismatch create new risks where drainage is weak. D. The 2020 GS-I wording invites examples beyond visible deserts, but strict UNCCD usage confines desertification to arid, semi-arid and dry sub-humid lands; humid cases are broader land degradation.

Answer: B. Explanation: Low and variable rainfall, erodible sediment, strong winds, saline basins and slow biological recovery create susceptibility without proving degradation. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q43. Which statement preserves the process boundary for Natural susceptibility?

A. Canal irrigation can support farming, water supply and settlement while seepage, waterlogging, salinity, invasive spread and crop-water mismatch create new risks where drainage is weak. B. Land Degradation Neutrality seeks to balance anticipated losses with measures that avoid, reduce and reverse degradation while protecting land-based natural capital. C. Low and variable rainfall, erodible sediment, strong winds, saline basins and slow biological recovery create susceptibility without proving degradation. D. The 2020 GS-I wording invites examples beyond visible deserts, but strict UNCCD usage confines desertification to arid, semi-arid and dry sub-humid lands; humid cases are broader land degradation.

Answer: C. Explanation: Low and variable rainfall, erodible sediment, strong winds, saline basins and slow biological recovery create susceptibility without proving degradation. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q44. Which option avoids the main UPSC trap concerning Natural susceptibility?

A. The 2020 GS-I wording invites examples beyond visible deserts, but strict UNCCD usage confines desertification to arid, semi-arid and dry sub-humid lands; humid cases are broader land degradation. B. Dune stabilisation, shelterbelts, native grass and rangeland recovery, watershed treatment, drainage, salinity management and community institutions must match the diagnosed process. C. Land Degradation Neutrality seeks to balance anticipated losses with measures that avoid, reduce and reverse degradation while protecting land-based natural capital. D. Low and variable rainfall, erodible sediment, strong winds, saline basins and slow biological recovery create susceptibility without proving degradation.

Answer: D. Explanation: Low and variable rainfall, erodible sediment, strong winds, saline basins and slow biological recovery create susceptibility without proving degradation. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q45. Which statement correctly explains Human accelerators?

A. Vegetation removal, poorly managed grazing, repeated tillage, groundwater stress, mining, infrastructure fragmentation and unsuitable irrigation can exceed recovery thresholds. B. The Aravalli influences relief, drainage, habitat connectivity and local erosion control, but it is not a complete wall that mechanically blocks all desert movement. C. The 2020 GS-I wording invites examples beyond visible deserts, but strict UNCCD usage confines desertification to arid, semi-arid and dry sub-humid lands; humid cases are broader land degradation. D. Canal irrigation can support farming, water supply and settlement while seepage, waterlogging, salinity, invasive spread and crop-water mismatch create new risks where drainage is weak.

Answer: A. Explanation: Vegetation removal, poorly managed grazing, repeated tillage, groundwater stress, mining, infrastructure fragmentation and unsuitable irrigation can exceed recovery thresholds. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q46. Which option is the safest spatial interpretation of Human accelerators?

A. Land Degradation Neutrality seeks to balance anticipated losses with measures that avoid, reduce and reverse degradation while protecting land-based natural capital. B. Vegetation removal, poorly managed grazing, repeated tillage, groundwater stress, mining, infrastructure fragmentation and unsuitable irrigation can exceed recovery thresholds. C. Canal irrigation can support farming, water supply and settlement while seepage, waterlogging, salinity, invasive spread and crop-water mismatch create new risks where drainage is weak. D. The 2020 GS-I wording invites examples beyond visible deserts, but strict UNCCD usage confines desertification to arid, semi-arid and dry sub-humid lands; humid cases are broader land degradation.

Answer: B. Explanation: Vegetation removal, poorly managed grazing, repeated tillage, groundwater stress, mining, infrastructure fragmentation and unsuitable irrigation can exceed recovery thresholds. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q47. Which statement preserves the process boundary for Human accelerators?

A. The 2020 GS-I wording invites examples beyond visible deserts, but strict UNCCD usage confines desertification to arid, semi-arid and dry sub-humid lands; humid cases are broader land degradation. B. Dune stabilisation, shelterbelts, native grass and rangeland recovery, watershed treatment, drainage, salinity management and community institutions must match the diagnosed process. C. Vegetation removal, poorly managed grazing, repeated tillage, groundwater stress, mining, infrastructure fragmentation and unsuitable irrigation can exceed recovery thresholds. D. Land Degradation Neutrality seeks to balance anticipated losses with measures that avoid, reduce and reverse degradation while protecting land-based natural capital.

Answer: C. Explanation: Vegetation removal, poorly managed grazing, repeated tillage, groundwater stress, mining, infrastructure fragmentation and unsuitable irrigation can exceed recovery thresholds. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q48. Which option avoids the main UPSC trap concerning Human accelerators?

A. Dune stabilisation, shelterbelts, native grass and rangeland recovery, watershed treatment, drainage, salinity management and community institutions must match the diagnosed process. B. Land Degradation Neutrality seeks to balance anticipated losses with measures that avoid, reduce and reverse degradation while protecting land-based natural capital. C. Land-cover change, vegetation productivity, soil carbon and field indicators need scale, baseline and causal interpretation; mapped degradation is not automatically current condition or programme impact. D. Vegetation removal, poorly managed grazing, repeated tillage, groundwater stress, mining, infrastructure fragmentation and unsuitable irrigation can exceed recovery thresholds.

Answer: D. Explanation: Vegetation removal, poorly managed grazing, repeated tillage, groundwater stress, mining, infrastructure fragmentation and unsuitable irrigation can exceed recovery thresholds. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q49. Which statement correctly explains Aravalli function?

A. The Aravalli influences relief, drainage, habitat connectivity and local erosion control, but it is not a complete wall that mechanically blocks all desert movement. B. Land Degradation Neutrality seeks to balance anticipated losses with measures that avoid, reduce and reverse degradation while protecting land-based natural capital. C. Canal irrigation can support farming, water supply and settlement while seepage, waterlogging, salinity, invasive spread and crop-water mismatch create new risks where drainage is weak. D. The 2020 GS-I wording invites examples beyond visible deserts, but strict UNCCD usage confines desertification to arid, semi-arid and dry sub-humid lands; humid cases are broader land degradation.

Answer: A. Explanation: The Aravalli influences relief, drainage, habitat connectivity and local erosion control, but it is not a complete wall that mechanically blocks all desert movement. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q50. Which option is the safest spatial interpretation of Aravalli function?

A. Dune stabilisation, shelterbelts, native grass and rangeland recovery, watershed treatment, drainage, salinity management and community institutions must match the diagnosed process. B. The Aravalli influences relief, drainage, habitat connectivity and local erosion control, but it is not a complete wall that mechanically blocks all desert movement. C. The 2020 GS-I wording invites examples beyond visible deserts, but strict UNCCD usage confines desertification to arid, semi-arid and dry sub-humid lands; humid cases are broader land degradation. D. Land Degradation Neutrality seeks to balance anticipated losses with measures that avoid, reduce and reverse degradation while protecting land-based natural capital.

Answer: B. Explanation: The Aravalli influences relief, drainage, habitat connectivity and local erosion control, but it is not a complete wall that mechanically blocks all desert movement. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q51. Which statement preserves the process boundary for Aravalli function?

A. Land Degradation Neutrality seeks to balance anticipated losses with measures that avoid, reduce and reverse degradation while protecting land-based natural capital. B. Land-cover change, vegetation productivity, soil carbon and field indicators need scale, baseline and causal interpretation; mapped degradation is not automatically current condition or programme impact. C. The Aravalli influences relief, drainage, habitat connectivity and local erosion control, but it is not a complete wall that mechanically blocks all desert movement. D. Dune stabilisation, shelterbelts, native grass and rangeland recovery, watershed treatment, drainage, salinity management and community institutions must match the diagnosed process.

Answer: C. Explanation: The Aravalli influences relief, drainage, habitat connectivity and local erosion control, but it is not a complete wall that mechanically blocks all desert movement. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q52. Which option avoids the main UPSC trap concerning Aravalli function?

A. The central routing ledger assigns the 2020 desertification demand to Environment and Ecology, and the checked ledgers contain no direct Geography Topic 07 route; those questions remain cross-owner context only. B. Dune stabilisation, shelterbelts, native grass and rangeland recovery, watershed treatment, drainage, salinity management and community institutions must match the diagnosed process. C. Land-cover change, vegetation productivity, soil carbon and field indicators need scale, baseline and causal interpretation; mapped degradation is not automatically current condition or programme impact. D. The Aravalli influences relief, drainage, habitat connectivity and local erosion control, but it is not a complete wall that mechanically blocks all desert movement.

Answer: D. Explanation: The Aravalli influences relief, drainage, habitat connectivity and local erosion control, but it is not a complete wall that mechanically blocks all desert movement. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q53. Which statement correctly explains Indira Gandhi Canal balance?

A. Canal irrigation can support farming, water supply and settlement while seepage, waterlogging, salinity, invasive spread and crop-water mismatch create new risks where drainage is weak. B. Dune stabilisation, shelterbelts, native grass and rangeland recovery, watershed treatment, drainage, salinity management and community institutions must match the diagnosed process. C. The 2020 GS-I wording invites examples beyond visible deserts, but strict UNCCD usage confines desertification to arid, semi-arid and dry sub-humid lands; humid cases are broader land degradation. D. Land Degradation Neutrality seeks to balance anticipated losses with measures that avoid, reduce and reverse degradation while protecting land-based natural capital.

Answer: A. Explanation: Canal irrigation can support farming, water supply and settlement while seepage, waterlogging, salinity, invasive spread and crop-water mismatch create new risks where drainage is weak. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q54. Which option is the safest spatial interpretation of Indira Gandhi Canal balance?

A. Land Degradation Neutrality seeks to balance anticipated losses with measures that avoid, reduce and reverse degradation while protecting land-based natural capital. B. Canal irrigation can support farming, water supply and settlement while seepage, waterlogging, salinity, invasive spread and crop-water mismatch create new risks where drainage is weak. C. Land-cover change, vegetation productivity, soil carbon and field indicators need scale, baseline and causal interpretation; mapped degradation is not automatically current condition or programme impact. D. Dune stabilisation, shelterbelts, native grass and rangeland recovery, watershed treatment, drainage, salinity management and community institutions must match the diagnosed process.

Answer: B. Explanation: Canal irrigation can support farming, water supply and settlement while seepage, waterlogging, salinity, invasive spread and crop-water mismatch create new risks where drainage is weak. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q55. Which statement preserves the process boundary for Indira Gandhi Canal balance?

A. Dune stabilisation, shelterbelts, native grass and rangeland recovery, watershed treatment, drainage, salinity management and community institutions must match the diagnosed process. B. The central routing ledger assigns the 2020 desertification demand to Environment and Ecology, and the checked ledgers contain no direct Geography Topic 07 route; those questions remain cross-owner context only. C. Canal irrigation can support farming, water supply and settlement while seepage, waterlogging, salinity, invasive spread and crop-water mismatch create new risks where drainage is weak. D. Land-cover change, vegetation productivity, soil carbon and field indicators need scale, baseline and causal interpretation; mapped degradation is not automatically current condition or programme impact.

Answer: C. Explanation: Canal irrigation can support farming, water supply and settlement while seepage, waterlogging, salinity, invasive spread and crop-water mismatch create new risks where drainage is weak. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q56. Which option avoids the main UPSC trap concerning Indira Gandhi Canal balance?

A. SAC's Desertification Status Mapping Atlas is an official dated mapping baseline and UNCCD's 2026 material keeps restoration current; neither licenses an invented current Thar percentage or COP outcome. B. Land-cover change, vegetation productivity, soil carbon and field indicators need scale, baseline and causal interpretation; mapped degradation is not automatically current condition or programme impact. C. The central routing ledger assigns the 2020 desertification demand to Environment and Ecology, and the checked ledgers contain no direct Geography Topic 07 route; those questions remain cross-owner context only. D. Canal irrigation can support farming, water supply and settlement while seepage, waterlogging, salinity, invasive spread and crop-water mismatch create new risks where drainage is weak.

Answer: D. Explanation: Canal irrigation can support farming, water supply and settlement while seepage, waterlogging, salinity, invasive spread and crop-water mismatch create new risks where drainage is weak. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q57. Which statement correctly explains Desertification beyond desert?

A. The 2020 GS-I wording invites examples beyond visible deserts, but strict UNCCD usage confines desertification to arid, semi-arid and dry sub-humid lands; humid cases are broader land degradation. B. Dune stabilisation, shelterbelts, native grass and rangeland recovery, watershed treatment, drainage, salinity management and community institutions must match the diagnosed process. C. Land Degradation Neutrality seeks to balance anticipated losses with measures that avoid, reduce and reverse degradation while protecting land-based natural capital. D. Land-cover change, vegetation productivity, soil carbon and field indicators need scale, baseline and causal interpretation; mapped degradation is not automatically current condition or programme impact.

Answer: A. Explanation: The 2020 GS-I wording invites examples beyond visible deserts, but strict UNCCD usage confines desertification to arid, semi-arid and dry sub-humid lands; humid cases are broader land degradation. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q58. Which option is the safest spatial interpretation of Desertification beyond desert?

A. Land-cover change, vegetation productivity, soil carbon and field indicators need scale, baseline and causal interpretation; mapped degradation is not automatically current condition or programme impact. B. The 2020 GS-I wording invites examples beyond visible deserts, but strict UNCCD usage confines desertification to arid, semi-arid and dry sub-humid lands; humid cases are broader land degradation. C. Dune stabilisation, shelterbelts, native grass and rangeland recovery, watershed treatment, drainage, salinity management and community institutions must match the diagnosed process. D. The central routing ledger assigns the 2020 desertification demand to Environment and Ecology, and the checked ledgers contain no direct Geography Topic 07 route; those questions remain cross-owner context only.

Answer: B. Explanation: The 2020 GS-I wording invites examples beyond visible deserts, but strict UNCCD usage confines desertification to arid, semi-arid and dry sub-humid lands; humid cases are broader land degradation. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q59. Which statement preserves the process boundary for Desertification beyond desert?

A. Land-cover change, vegetation productivity, soil carbon and field indicators need scale, baseline and causal interpretation; mapped degradation is not automatically current condition or programme impact. B. The central routing ledger assigns the 2020 desertification demand to Environment and Ecology, and the checked ledgers contain no direct Geography Topic 07 route; those questions remain cross-owner context only. C. The 2020 GS-I wording invites examples beyond visible deserts, but strict UNCCD usage confines desertification to arid, semi-arid and dry sub-humid lands; humid cases are broader land degradation. D. SAC's Desertification Status Mapping Atlas is an official dated mapping baseline and UNCCD's 2026 material keeps restoration current; neither licenses an invented current Thar percentage or COP outcome.

Answer: C. Explanation: The 2020 GS-I wording invites examples beyond visible deserts, but strict UNCCD usage confines desertification to arid, semi-arid and dry sub-humid lands; humid cases are broader land degradation. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q60. Which option avoids the main UPSC trap concerning Desertification beyond desert?

A. SAC's Desertification Status Mapping Atlas is an official dated mapping baseline and UNCCD's 2026 material keeps restoration current; neither licenses an invented current Thar percentage or COP outcome. B. A desert is a climatic region, aridity a long-term moisture deficit, drought a temporary anomaly, land degradation a broad decline in condition, and desertification dryland degradation. C. The central routing ledger assigns the 2020 desertification demand to Environment and Ecology, and the checked ledgers contain no direct Geography Topic 07 route; those questions remain cross-owner context only. D. The 2020 GS-I wording invites examples beyond visible deserts, but strict UNCCD usage confines desertification to arid, semi-arid and dry sub-humid lands; humid cases are broader land degradation.

Answer: D. Explanation: The 2020 GS-I wording invites examples beyond visible deserts, but strict UNCCD usage confines desertification to arid, semi-arid and dry sub-humid lands; humid cases are broader land degradation. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q61. Which statement correctly explains LDN logic?

A. Land Degradation Neutrality seeks to balance anticipated losses with measures that avoid, reduce and reverse degradation while protecting land-based natural capital. B. Land-cover change, vegetation productivity, soil carbon and field indicators need scale, baseline and causal interpretation; mapped degradation is not automatically current condition or programme impact. C. The central routing ledger assigns the 2020 desertification demand to Environment and Ecology, and the checked ledgers contain no direct Geography Topic 07 route; those questions remain cross-owner context only. D. Dune stabilisation, shelterbelts, native grass and rangeland recovery, watershed treatment, drainage, salinity management and community institutions must match the diagnosed process.

Answer: A. Explanation: Land Degradation Neutrality seeks to balance anticipated losses with measures that avoid, reduce and reverse degradation while protecting land-based natural capital. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q62. Which option is the safest spatial interpretation of LDN logic?

A. Land-cover change, vegetation productivity, soil carbon and field indicators need scale, baseline and causal interpretation; mapped degradation is not automatically current condition or programme impact. B. Land Degradation Neutrality seeks to balance anticipated losses with measures that avoid, reduce and reverse degradation while protecting land-based natural capital. C. SAC's Desertification Status Mapping Atlas is an official dated mapping baseline and UNCCD's 2026 material keeps restoration current; neither licenses an invented current Thar percentage or COP outcome. D. The central routing ledger assigns the 2020 desertification demand to Environment and Ecology, and the checked ledgers contain no direct Geography Topic 07 route; those questions remain cross-owner context only.

Answer: B. Explanation: Land Degradation Neutrality seeks to balance anticipated losses with measures that avoid, reduce and reverse degradation while protecting land-based natural capital. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q63. Which statement preserves the process boundary for LDN logic?

A. The central routing ledger assigns the 2020 desertification demand to Environment and Ecology, and the checked ledgers contain no direct Geography Topic 07 route; those questions remain cross-owner context only. B. A desert is a climatic region, aridity a long-term moisture deficit, drought a temporary anomaly, land degradation a broad decline in condition, and desertification dryland degradation. C. Land Degradation Neutrality seeks to balance anticipated losses with measures that avoid, reduce and reverse degradation while protecting land-based natural capital. D. SAC's Desertification Status Mapping Atlas is an official dated mapping baseline and UNCCD's 2026 material keeps restoration current; neither licenses an invented current Thar percentage or COP outcome.

Answer: C. Explanation: Land Degradation Neutrality seeks to balance anticipated losses with measures that avoid, reduce and reverse degradation while protecting land-based natural capital. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q64. Which option avoids the main UPSC trap concerning LDN logic?

A. Subtropical subsidence, continentality, rain shadow, cold currents and polar cold can create deserts; heat alone is neither necessary nor sufficient. B. A desert is a climatic region, aridity a long-term moisture deficit, drought a temporary anomaly, land degradation a broad decline in condition, and desertification dryland degradation. C. SAC's Desertification Status Mapping Atlas is an official dated mapping baseline and UNCCD's 2026 material keeps restoration current; neither licenses an invented current Thar percentage or COP outcome. D. Land Degradation Neutrality seeks to balance anticipated losses with measures that avoid, reduce and reverse degradation while protecting land-based natural capital.

Answer: D. Explanation: Land Degradation Neutrality seeks to balance anticipated losses with measures that avoid, reduce and reverse degradation while protecting land-based natural capital. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q65. Which statement correctly explains Process-matched restoration?

A. Dune stabilisation, shelterbelts, native grass and rangeland recovery, watershed treatment, drainage, salinity management and community institutions must match the diagnosed process. B. SAC's Desertification Status Mapping Atlas is an official dated mapping baseline and UNCCD's 2026 material keeps restoration current; neither licenses an invented current Thar percentage or COP outcome. C. Land-cover change, vegetation productivity, soil carbon and field indicators need scale, baseline and causal interpretation; mapped degradation is not automatically current condition or programme impact. D. The central routing ledger assigns the 2020 desertification demand to Environment and Ecology, and the checked ledgers contain no direct Geography Topic 07 route; those questions remain cross-owner context only.

Answer: A. Explanation: Dune stabilisation, shelterbelts, native grass and rangeland recovery, watershed treatment, drainage, salinity management and community institutions must match the diagnosed process. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q66. Which option is the safest spatial interpretation of Process-matched restoration?

A. A desert is a climatic region, aridity a long-term moisture deficit, drought a temporary anomaly, land degradation a broad decline in condition, and desertification dryland degradation. B. Dune stabilisation, shelterbelts, native grass and rangeland recovery, watershed treatment, drainage, salinity management and community institutions must match the diagnosed process. C. The central routing ledger assigns the 2020 desertification demand to Environment and Ecology, and the checked ledgers contain no direct Geography Topic 07 route; those questions remain cross-owner context only. D. SAC's Desertification Status Mapping Atlas is an official dated mapping baseline and UNCCD's 2026 material keeps restoration current; neither licenses an invented current Thar percentage or COP outcome.

Answer: B. Explanation: Dune stabilisation, shelterbelts, native grass and rangeland recovery, watershed treatment, drainage, salinity management and community institutions must match the diagnosed process. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q67. Which statement preserves the process boundary for Process-matched restoration?

A. Subtropical subsidence, continentality, rain shadow, cold currents and polar cold can create deserts; heat alone is neither necessary nor sufficient. B. A desert is a climatic region, aridity a long-term moisture deficit, drought a temporary anomaly, land degradation a broad decline in condition, and desertification dryland degradation. C. Dune stabilisation, shelterbelts, native grass and rangeland recovery, watershed treatment, drainage, salinity management and community institutions must match the diagnosed process. D. SAC's Desertification Status Mapping Atlas is an official dated mapping baseline and UNCCD's 2026 material keeps restoration current; neither licenses an invented current Thar percentage or COP outcome.

Answer: C. Explanation: Dune stabilisation, shelterbelts, native grass and rangeland recovery, watershed treatment, drainage, salinity management and community institutions must match the diagnosed process. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q68. Which option avoids the main UPSC trap concerning Process-matched restoration?

A. Subtropical subsidence, continentality, rain shadow, cold currents and polar cold can create deserts; heat alone is neither necessary nor sufficient. B. Large thermal ranges, salt crystallisation and episodic wetting weaken exposed rock, while sparse cover leaves debris available to wind and flash runoff. C. A desert is a climatic region, aridity a long-term moisture deficit, drought a temporary anomaly, land degradation a broad decline in condition, and desertification dryland degradation. D. Dune stabilisation, shelterbelts, native grass and rangeland recovery, watershed treatment, drainage, salinity management and community institutions must match the diagnosed process.

Answer: D. Explanation: Dune stabilisation, shelterbelts, native grass and rangeland recovery, watershed treatment, drainage, salinity management and community institutions must match the diagnosed process. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q69. Which statement correctly explains Monitoring discipline?

A. Land-cover change, vegetation productivity, soil carbon and field indicators need scale, baseline and causal interpretation; mapped degradation is not automatically current condition or programme impact. B. A desert is a climatic region, aridity a long-term moisture deficit, drought a temporary anomaly, land degradation a broad decline in condition, and desertification dryland degradation. C. The central routing ledger assigns the 2020 desertification demand to Environment and Ecology, and the checked ledgers contain no direct Geography Topic 07 route; those questions remain cross-owner context only. D. SAC's Desertification Status Mapping Atlas is an official dated mapping baseline and UNCCD's 2026 material keeps restoration current; neither licenses an invented current Thar percentage or COP outcome.

Answer: A. Explanation: Land-cover change, vegetation productivity, soil carbon and field indicators need scale, baseline and causal interpretation; mapped degradation is not automatically current condition or programme impact. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q70. Which option is the safest spatial interpretation of Monitoring discipline?

A. SAC's Desertification Status Mapping Atlas is an official dated mapping baseline and UNCCD's 2026 material keeps restoration current; neither licenses an invented current Thar percentage or COP outcome. B. Land-cover change, vegetation productivity, soil carbon and field indicators need scale, baseline and causal interpretation; mapped degradation is not automatically current condition or programme impact. C. Subtropical subsidence, continentality, rain shadow, cold currents and polar cold can create deserts; heat alone is neither necessary nor sufficient. D. A desert is a climatic region, aridity a long-term moisture deficit, drought a temporary anomaly, land degradation a broad decline in condition, and desertification dryland degradation.

Answer: B. Explanation: Land-cover change, vegetation productivity, soil carbon and field indicators need scale, baseline and causal interpretation; mapped degradation is not automatically current condition or programme impact. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q71. Which statement preserves the process boundary for Monitoring discipline?

A. A desert is a climatic region, aridity a long-term moisture deficit, drought a temporary anomaly, land degradation a broad decline in condition, and desertification dryland degradation. B. Subtropical subsidence, continentality, rain shadow, cold currents and polar cold can create deserts; heat alone is neither necessary nor sufficient. C. Land-cover change, vegetation productivity, soil carbon and field indicators need scale, baseline and causal interpretation; mapped degradation is not automatically current condition or programme impact. D. Large thermal ranges, salt crystallisation and episodic wetting weaken exposed rock, while sparse cover leaves debris available to wind and flash runoff.

Answer: C. Explanation: Land-cover change, vegetation productivity, soil carbon and field indicators need scale, baseline and causal interpretation; mapped degradation is not automatically current condition or programme impact. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q72. Which option avoids the main UPSC trap concerning Monitoring discipline?

A. Subtropical subsidence, continentality, rain shadow, cold currents and polar cold can create deserts; heat alone is neither necessary nor sufficient. B. Wind moves coarse particles mainly by surface creep, sand by saltation and fine dust by suspension; deflation removes loose material and abrasion sandblasts exposed surfaces. C. Large thermal ranges, salt crystallisation and episodic wetting weaken exposed rock, while sparse cover leaves debris available to wind and flash runoff. D. Land-cover change, vegetation productivity, soil carbon and field indicators need scale, baseline and causal interpretation; mapped degradation is not automatically current condition or programme impact.

Answer: D. Explanation: Land-cover change, vegetation productivity, soil carbon and field indicators need scale, baseline and causal interpretation; mapped degradation is not automatically current condition or programme impact. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q73. Which statement correctly explains Verified PYQ boundary?

A. The central routing ledger assigns the 2020 desertification demand to Environment and Ecology, and the checked ledgers contain no direct Geography Topic 07 route; those questions remain cross-owner context only. B. SAC's Desertification Status Mapping Atlas is an official dated mapping baseline and UNCCD's 2026 material keeps restoration current; neither licenses an invented current Thar percentage or COP outcome. C. A desert is a climatic region, aridity a long-term moisture deficit, drought a temporary anomaly, land degradation a broad decline in condition, and desertification dryland degradation. D. Subtropical subsidence, continentality, rain shadow, cold currents and polar cold can create deserts; heat alone is neither necessary nor sufficient.

Answer: A. Explanation: The central routing ledger assigns the 2020 desertification demand to Environment and Ecology, and the checked ledgers contain no direct Geography Topic 07 route; those questions remain cross-owner context only. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on “Q73. Which statement correctly explains Verified PYQ boundary?”, all clauses and scales, a process chain, spatial reconstruction, named India/world evidence, a counter-condition and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: The answer must resolve the physical-geography demand in “Q73. Which statement correctly explains Verified PYQ boundary?”.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Q73. Which statement correctly explains Verified PYQ boundary? **Analysis:** Trace the driver -> mechanism -> spatial expression -> consequence chain and connect the named place, map or observation to the directive. **Qualification:** State the scale, threshold, interacting control, exception or source/date boundary.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** A. The central routing ledger assigns the 2020 desertification demand to Environment and Ecology, and the checked ledgers contain no direct Geography Topic 07 route; those questions remain cross-owner context only. **Analysis:** Trace the driver -> mechanism -> spatial expression -> consequence chain and connect the named place, map or observation to the directive. **Qualification:** State the scale, threshold, interacting control, exception or source/date boundary.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** B. SAC's Desertification Status Mapping Atlas is an official dated mapping baseline and UNCCD's 2026 material keeps restoration current; neither licenses an invented current Thar percentage or COP outcome. **Analysis:** Trace the driver -> mechanism -> spatial expression -> consequence chain and connect the named place, map or observation to the directive. **Qualification:** State the scale, threshold, interacting control, exception or source/date boundary.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** C. A desert is a climatic region, aridity a long-term moisture deficit, drought a temporary anomaly, land degradation a broad decline in condition, and desertification dryland degradation. **Analysis:** Trace the driver -> mechanism -> spatial expression -> consequence chain and connect the named place, map or observation to the directive. **Qualification:** State the scale, threshold, interacting control, exception or source/date boundary.
5. **Claim and named evidence:** D. Subtropical subsidence, continentality, rain shadow, cold currents and polar cold can create deserts; heat alone is neither necessary nor sufficient. **Analysis:** Trace the driver -> mechanism -> spatial expression -> consequence chain and connect the named place, map or observation to the directive. **Qualification:** State the scale, threshold, interacting control, exception or source/date boundary.

Counter-position / limit: A spatial association, one event, one model or one map layer does not establish a sufficient or timeless cause; test energy, material, structure, circulation, scale and human mediation.

Qualified conclusion: The answer must resolve the physical-geography demand in “Q73. Which statement correctly explains Verified PYQ boundary?”.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For a 15-mark answer, spend about one-sixth of the time decoding and drawing the map/flow; open with definition and thesis; organise five process-spatial points as claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification; compress examples before mechanisms and reserve the final minute for

the causal limit.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains rather than catalogues, makes the spatial logic visible and avoids deterministic or timeless claims.

How to improve this answer: For “Q73. Which statement correctly explains Verified PYQ boundary?”, replace the weakest generalisation with one labelled process arrow or map anchor and state the scale, exception or evidence needed before extending the conclusion.

Q74. Which option is the safest spatial interpretation of Verified PYQ boundary?

A. A desert is a climatic region, aridity a long-term moisture deficit, drought a temporary anomaly, land degradation a broad decline in condition, and desertification dryland degradation. B. The central routing ledger assigns the 2020 desertification demand to Environment and Ecology, and the checked ledgers contain no direct Geography Topic 07 route; those questions remain cross-owner context only. C. Subtropical subsidence, continentality, rain shadow, cold currents and polar cold can create deserts; heat alone is neither necessary nor sufficient. D. Large thermal ranges, salt crystallisation and episodic wetting weaken exposed rock, while sparse cover leaves debris available to wind and flash runoff.

Answer: B. Explanation: The central routing ledger assigns the 2020 desertification demand to Environment and Ecology, and the checked ledgers contain no direct Geography Topic 07 route; those questions remain cross-owner context only. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Demand decoding: Treat “Q74. Which option is the safest spatial interpretation of Verified PYQ boundary?” as a process, location, scale, terminology and status problem. Verify every statement independently.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: The answer must resolve the physical-geography demand in “Q74. Which option is the safest spatial interpretation of Verified PYQ boundary?”.

Analytical body:

- 1. Claim and named evidence:** Q74. Which option is the safest spatial interpretation of Verified PYQ boundary?
Analysis: Trace the driver -> mechanism -> spatial expression -> consequence chain and connect the named place, map or observation to the directive. **Qualification:** State the scale, threshold, interacting control, exception or source/date boundary.
- 2. Claim and named evidence:** A. A desert is a climatic region, aridity a long-term moisture deficit, drought a temporary anomaly, land degradation a broad decline in condition, and desertification dryland degradation.
Analysis: Trace the driver -> mechanism -> spatial expression -> consequence chain and connect the named place, map or observation to the directive. **Qualification:** State the scale, threshold, interacting control, exception or source/date boundary.
- 3. Claim and named evidence:** B. The central routing ledger assigns the 2020 desertification demand to Environment and Ecology, and the checked ledgers contain no direct Geography Topic 07 route; those questions remain cross-owner context only. **Analysis:** Trace the driver -> mechanism -> spatial expression -> consequence chain and connect the named place, map or observation to the directive. **Qualification:** State the scale, threshold, interacting control, exception or source/date boundary.
- 4. Claim and named evidence:** C. Subtropical subsidence, continentality, rain shadow, cold currents and polar cold can create deserts; heat alone is neither necessary nor sufficient. **Analysis:** Trace the driver -> mechanism -> spatial expression -> consequence chain and connect the named place, map or observation to the directive. **Qualification:** State the scale, threshold, interacting control, exception or source/date boundary.
- 5. Claim and named evidence:** D. Large thermal ranges, salt crystallisation and episodic wetting weaken exposed rock, while sparse cover leaves debris available to wind and flash runoff. **Analysis:** Trace the driver -> mechanism -> spatial expression -> consequence chain and connect the named place, map or observation to the directive. **Qualification:** State the scale, threshold, interacting control, exception or source/date boundary.

Counter-position / limit: A spatial association, one event, one model or one map layer does not establish a sufficient or timeless cause; test energy, material, structure, circulation, scale and human mediation.

Qualified conclusion: The answer must resolve the physical-geography demand in “Q74. Which option is the safest spatial interpretation of Verified PYQ boundary?”.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: Fix the phenomenon and spatial setting; trace the controlling mechanism; test direction, sequence, threshold and India/world anchor; eliminate the closest term, map or causation distractor.

Why this earns marks: It preserves exact process-to-pattern reasoning and prevents a familiar place-name or correlation from substituting for causation.

How to improve this answer: For “Q74. Which option is the safest spatial interpretation of Verified PYQ boundary?”, state why the nearest distractor fails on process, direction, scale, location, terminology, date or official status.

Q75. Which statement preserves the process boundary for Verified PYQ boundary?

A. Wind moves coarse particles mainly by surface creep, sand by saltation and fine dust by suspension; deflation removes loose material and abrasion sandblasts exposed surfaces. B. Subtropical subsidence, continentality, rain shadow, cold currents and polar cold can create deserts; heat alone is neither necessary nor sufficient. C. The central routing ledger assigns the 2020 desertification demand to Environment and Ecology, and the checked ledgers contain no direct Geography Topic 07 route; those questions remain cross-owner context only. D. Large thermal ranges, salt crystallisation and episodic wetting weaken exposed rock, while sparse cover leaves debris available to wind and flash runoff.

Answer: C. Explanation: The central routing ledger assigns the 2020 desertification demand to Environment and Ecology, and the checked ledgers contain no direct Geography Topic 07 route; those questions remain cross-owner context only. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on “Q75. Which statement preserves the process boundary for Verified PYQ boundary?”, all clauses and scales, a process chain, spatial reconstruction, named India/world evidence, a counter-condition and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: The answer must resolve the physical-geography demand in “Q75. Which statement preserves the process boundary for Verified PYQ boundary?”.

Analytical body:

- Claim and named evidence:** Q75. Which statement preserves the process boundary for Verified PYQ boundary? **Analysis:** Trace the driver -> mechanism -> spatial expression -> consequence chain and connect the named place, map or observation to the directive. **Qualification:** State the scale, threshold, interacting control, exception or source/date boundary.
- Claim and named evidence:** A. Wind moves coarse particles mainly by surface creep, sand by saltation and fine dust by suspension; deflation removes loose material and abrasion sandblasts exposed surfaces. **Analysis:** Trace the driver -> mechanism -> spatial expression -> consequence chain and connect the named place, map or observation to the directive. **Qualification:** State the scale, threshold, interacting control, exception or source/date boundary.
- Claim and named evidence:** B. Subtropical subsidence, continentality, rain shadow, cold currents and polar cold can create deserts; heat alone is neither necessary nor sufficient. **Analysis:** Trace the driver -> mechanism -> spatial expression -> consequence chain and connect the named place, map or observation to the directive. **Qualification:** State the scale, threshold, interacting control, exception or source/date boundary.
- Claim and named evidence:** C. The central routing ledger assigns the 2020 desertification demand to Environment and Ecology, and the checked ledgers contain no direct Geography Topic 07 route; those questions remain cross-owner context only. **Analysis:** Trace the driver -> mechanism -> spatial expression -> consequence chain and connect the named place, map or observation to the directive. **Qualification:** State the scale, threshold, interacting control, exception or source/date boundary.
- Claim and named evidence:** D. Large thermal ranges, salt crystallisation and episodic wetting weaken exposed rock, while sparse cover leaves debris available to wind and flash runoff. **Analysis:** Trace the driver -> mechanism

-> spatial expression -> consequence chain and connect the named place, map or observation to the directive.

Qualification: State the scale, threshold, interacting control, exception or source/date boundary.

Counter-position / limit: A spatial association, one event, one model or one map layer does not establish a sufficient or timeless cause; test energy, material, structure, circulation, scale and human mediation.

Qualified conclusion: The answer must resolve the physical-geography demand in "Q75. Which statement preserves the process boundary for Verified PYQ boundary?"

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For a 15-mark answer, spend about one-sixth of the time decoding and drawing the map/flow; open with definition and thesis; organise five process-spatial points as claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification; compress examples before mechanisms and reserve the final minute for the causal limit.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains rather than catalogues, makes the spatial logic visible and avoids deterministic or timeless claims.

How to improve this answer: For "Q75. Which statement preserves the process boundary for Verified PYQ boundary?", replace the weakest generalisation with one labelled process arrow or map anchor and state the scale, exception or evidence needed before extending the conclusion.

Q76. Which option avoids the main UPSC trap concerning Verified PYQ boundary?

A. Deflation hollows, desert pavement, ventifacts, yardangs, zeugens, rock pedestals and inselbergs reflect different combinations of wind, structure and weathering. B. Wind moves coarse particles mainly by surface creep, sand by saltation and fine dust by suspension; deflation removes loose material and abrasion sandblasts exposed surfaces. C. Large thermal ranges, salt crystallisation and episodic wetting weaken exposed rock, while sparse cover leaves debris available to wind and flash runoff. D. The central routing ledger assigns the 2020 desertification demand to Environment and Ecology, and the checked ledgers contain no direct Geography Topic 07 route; those questions remain cross-owner context only.

Answer: D. Explanation: The central routing ledger assigns the 2020 desertification demand to Environment and Ecology, and the checked ledgers contain no direct Geography Topic 07 route; those questions remain cross-owner context only. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q77. Which statement correctly explains Current evidence boundary?

A. SAC's Desertification Status Mapping Atlas is an official dated mapping baseline and UNCCD's 2026 material keeps restoration current; neither licenses an invented current Thar percentage or COP outcome. B. A desert is a climatic region, aridity a long-term moisture deficit, drought a temporary anomaly, land degradation a broad decline in condition, and desertification dryland degradation. C. Subtropical subsidence, continentality, rain shadow, cold currents and polar cold can create deserts; heat alone is neither necessary nor sufficient. D. Large thermal ranges, salt crystallisation and episodic wetting weaken exposed rock, while sparse cover leaves debris available to wind and flash runoff.

Answer: A. Explanation: SAC's Desertification Status Mapping Atlas is an official dated mapping baseline and UNCCD's 2026 material keeps restoration current; neither licenses an invented current Thar percentage or COP outcome. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q78. Which option is the safest spatial interpretation of Current evidence boundary?

A. Large thermal ranges, salt crystallisation and episodic wetting weaken exposed rock, while sparse cover leaves debris available to wind and flash runoff. B. SAC's Desertification Status Mapping Atlas is an official dated mapping baseline and UNCCD's 2026 material keeps restoration current; neither licenses an invented current Thar percentage or COP outcome. C. Wind moves coarse particles mainly by surface creep, sand by saltation and fine dust by suspension; deflation removes loose material and abrasion sandblasts exposed surfaces. D. Subtropical subsidence, continentality, rain shadow, cold currents and polar cold can create deserts; heat alone is neither necessary nor sufficient.

Answer: B. Explanation: SAC's Desertification Status Mapping Atlas is an official dated mapping baseline and UNCCD's 2026 material keeps restoration current; neither licenses an invented current Thar percentage or COP outcome. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q79. Which statement preserves the process boundary for Current evidence boundary?

A. Wind moves coarse particles mainly by surface creep, sand by saltation and fine dust by suspension; deflation removes loose material and abrasion sandblasts exposed surfaces. B. Large thermal ranges, salt crystallisation and episodic wetting weaken exposed rock, while sparse cover leaves debris available to wind and flash runoff. C. SAC's Desertification Status Mapping Atlas is an official dated mapping baseline and UNCCD's 2026 material keeps restoration current; neither licenses an invented current Thar percentage or COP outcome. D. Deflation hollows, desert pavement, ventifacts, yardangs, zeugens, rock pedestals and inselbergs reflect different combinations of wind, structure and weathering.

Answer: C. Explanation: SAC's Desertification Status Mapping Atlas is an official dated mapping baseline and UNCCD's 2026 material keeps restoration current; neither licenses an invented current Thar percentage or COP outcome. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q80. Which option avoids the main UPSC trap concerning Current evidence boundary?

A. Wind moves coarse particles mainly by surface creep, sand by saltation and fine dust by suspension; deflation removes loose material and abrasion sandblasts exposed surfaces. B. Deflation hollows, desert pavement, ventifacts, yardangs, zeugens, rock pedestals and inselbergs reflect different combinations of wind, structure and weathering. C. A barchan has horns pointing downwind under limited sand and one prevailing wind; transverse, longitudinal, parabolic and star dunes indicate different sand, vegetation and wind regimes. D. SAC's Desertification Status Mapping Atlas is an official dated mapping baseline and UNCCD's 2026 material keeps restoration current; neither licenses an invented current Thar percentage or COP outcome.

Answer: D. Explanation: SAC's Desertification Status Mapping Atlas is an official dated mapping baseline and UNCCD's 2026 material keeps restoration current; neither licenses an invented current Thar percentage or COP outcome. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

Demand decoding: Treat “Q76. Which option avoids the main UPSC trap concerning Verified PYQ boundary?” as a process, location, scale, terminology and status problem. Verify every statement independently.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: The answer must resolve the physical-geography demand in “Q76. Which option avoids the main UPSC trap concerning Verified PYQ boundary?”.

Analytical body:

- 1. Claim and named evidence:** Q76. Which option avoids the main UPSC trap concerning Verified PYQ boundary?
Analysis: Trace the driver -> mechanism -> spatial expression -> consequence chain and connect the named place, map or observation to the directive. **Qualification:** State the scale, threshold, interacting control, exception or source/date boundary.
- 2. Claim and named evidence:** A. Deflation hollows, desert pavement, ventifacts, yardangs, zeugens, rock pedestals and inselbergs reflect different combinations of wind, structure and weathering. **Analysis:** Trace the driver -> mechanism -> spatial expression -> consequence chain and connect the named place, map or observation to the directive. **Qualification:** State the scale, threshold, interacting control, exception or source/date boundary.
- 3. Claim and named evidence:** B. Wind moves coarse particles mainly by surface creep, sand by saltation and fine dust by suspension; deflation removes loose material and abrasion sandblasts exposed surfaces. **Analysis:** Trace the driver -> mechanism -> spatial expression -> consequence chain and connect the named place, map or observation to the directive. **Qualification:** State the scale, threshold, interacting control, exception or source/date boundary.

4. **Claim and named evidence:** C. Large thermal ranges, salt crystallisation and episodic wetting weaken exposed rock, while sparse cover leaves debris available to wind and flash runoff. **Analysis:** Trace the driver -> mechanism -> spatial expression -> consequence chain and connect the named place, map or observation to the directive. **Qualification:** State the scale, threshold, interacting control, exception or source/date boundary.
5. **Claim and named evidence:** D. The central routing ledger assigns the 2020 desertification demand to Environment and Ecology, and the checked ledgers contain no direct Geography Topic 07 route; those questions remain cross-owner context only. **Analysis:** Trace the driver -> mechanism -> spatial expression -> consequence chain and connect the named place, map or observation to the directive. **Qualification:** State the scale, threshold, interacting control, exception or source/date boundary.

Counter-position / limit: A spatial association, one event, one model or one map layer does not establish a sufficient or timeless cause; test energy, material, structure, circulation, scale and human mediation.

Qualified conclusion: The answer must resolve the physical-geography demand in “Q76. Which option avoids the main UPSC trap concerning Verified PYQ boundary?”.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: Fix the phenomenon and spatial setting; trace the controlling mechanism; test direction, sequence, threshold and India/world anchor; eliminate the closest term, map or causation distractor.

Why this earns marks: It preserves exact process-to-pattern reasoning and prevents a familiar place-name or correlation from substituting for causation.

How to improve this answer: For “Q76. Which option avoids the main UPSC trap concerning Verified PYQ boundary?”, state why the nearest distractor fails on process, direction, scale, location, terminology, date or official status.

TRANSPARENT ZERO-DIRECT-PYQ AUDIT

TRANSPARENT ZERO-DIRECT-PYQ AUDIT: the central Mains ledger routes the 2020 desertification demand to Environment and Ecology, and no direct Topic 07 objective route appears in the checked central ledgers. Cross-owned questions remain conceptual context, not claimed Geography PYQs.

ORIGINAL MAINS 1 - 10 MARKS

Question: Differentiate desert, aridity, drought, land degradation and desertification. Answer in about 150 words.

Model thesis: The concepts occupy different climatic, temporal and ecological levels; policy fails when they are collapsed.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- A desert is a climatic region, aridity a long-term moisture deficit, drought a temporary anomaly, land degradation a broad decline in condition, and desertification dryland degradation.
- The 2020 GS-I wording invites examples beyond visible deserts, but strict UNCCD usage confines desertification to arid, semi-arid and dry sub-humid lands; humid cases are broader land degradation.

Qualified conclusion: The concepts occupy different climatic, temporal and ecological levels; policy fails when they are collapsed.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on “Differentiate desert, aridity, drought, land degradation and desertification. Answer in about...”, all clauses and scales, a process chain, spatial reconstruction, named India/world evidence, a counter-condition and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: The concepts occupy different climatic, temporal and ecological levels; policy fails when they are collapsed.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** A desert is a climatic region, aridity a long-term moisture deficit, drought a temporary anomaly, land degradation a broad decline in condition, and desertification dryland degradation. **Analysis:** Trace the driver -> mechanism -> spatial expression -> consequence chain and connect the named

place, map or observation to the directive. **Qualification:** State the scale, threshold, interacting control, exception or source/date boundary.

2. **Claim and named evidence:** The 2020 GS-I wording invites examples beyond visible deserts, but strict UNCCD usage confines desertification to arid, semi-arid and dry sub-humid lands; humid cases are broader land degradation. **Analysis:** Trace the driver -> mechanism -> spatial expression -> consequence chain and connect the named place, map or observation to the directive. **Qualification:** State the scale, threshold, interacting control, exception or source/date boundary.

Counter-position / limit: A spatial association, one event, one model or one map layer does not establish a sufficient or timeless cause; test energy, material, structure, circulation, scale and human mediation.

Qualified conclusion: The concepts occupy different climatic, temporal and ecological levels; policy fails when they are collapsed.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For a 10-mark answer, spend about one-sixth of the time decoding and drawing the map/flow; open with definition and thesis; organise three process-spatial points as claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification; compress examples before mechanisms and reserve the final minute for the causal limit.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains rather than catalogues, makes the spatial logic visible and avoids deterministic or timeless claims.

How to improve this answer: For “Differentiate desert, aridity, drought, land degradation and desertification. Answer in about...”, replace the weakest generalisation with one labelled process arrow or map anchor and state the scale, exception or evidence needed before extending the conclusion.

ORIGINAL MAINS 2 - 10 MARKS

Question: Explain how wind and episodic water jointly create arid landforms. Answer in about 150 words.

Model thesis: Aeolian erosion and deposition interact with weathering, flash runoff, fan building, playa flooding and evaporation.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Large thermal ranges, salt crystallisation and episodic wetting weaken exposed rock, while sparse cover leaves debris available to wind and flash runoff.
- Wind moves coarse particles mainly by surface creep, sand by saltation and fine dust by suspension; deflation removes loose material and abrasion sandblasts exposed surfaces.
- Deflation hollows, desert pavement, ventifacts, yardangs, zeugens, rock pedestals and inselbergs reflect different combinations of wind, structure and weathering.
- A barchan has horns pointing downwind under limited sand and one prevailing wind; transverse, longitudinal, parabolic and star dunes indicate different sand, vegetation and wind regimes.
- Wadis, alluvial fans, bajadas, pediments, playas and salt flats show that episodic runoff and evaporation are integral to desert geomorphology.

Qualified conclusion: Aeolian erosion and deposition interact with weathering, flash runoff, fan building, playa flooding and evaporation.

Demand decoding: The directive **explain** requires a direct position on “Explain how wind and episodic water jointly create arid landforms. Answer in about 150 words.”, all clauses and scales, a process chain, spatial reconstruction, named India/world evidence, a counter-condition and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Aeolian erosion and deposition interact with weathering, flash runoff, fan building, playa flooding and evaporation.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Large thermal ranges, salt crystallisation and episodic wetting weaken exposed rock, while sparse cover leaves debris available to wind and flash runoff. **Analysis:** Trace the driver -> mechanism -> spatial expression -> consequence chain and connect the named place, map or observation to the directive.

Qualification: State the scale, threshold, interacting control, exception or source/date boundary.

2. **Claim and named evidence:** Wind moves coarse particles mainly by surface creep, sand by saltation and fine dust by suspension; deflation removes loose material and abrasion sandblasts exposed surfaces. **Analysis:** Trace the driver -> mechanism -> spatial expression -> consequence chain and connect the named place, map or observation to the directive. **Qualification:** State the scale, threshold, interacting control, exception or source/date boundary.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** Deflation hollows, desert pavement, ventifacts, yardangs, zeugens, rock pedestals and inselbergs reflect different combinations of wind, structure and weathering. **Analysis:** Trace the driver -> mechanism -> spatial expression -> consequence chain and connect the named place, map or observation to the directive. **Qualification:** State the scale, threshold, interacting control, exception or source/date boundary.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** A barchan has horns pointing downwind under limited sand and one prevailing wind; transverse, longitudinal, parabolic and star dunes indicate different sand, vegetation and wind regimes. **Analysis:** Trace the driver -> mechanism -> spatial expression -> consequence chain and connect the named place, map or observation to the directive. **Qualification:** State the scale, threshold, interacting control, exception or source/date boundary.
5. **Claim and named evidence:** Wadis, alluvial fans, bajadas, pediments, playas and salt flats show that episodic runoff and evaporation are integral to desert geomorphology. **Analysis:** Trace the driver -> mechanism -> spatial expression -> consequence chain and connect the named place, map or observation to the directive. **Qualification:** State the scale, threshold, interacting control, exception or source/date boundary.

Counter-position / limit: A spatial association, one event, one model or one map layer does not establish a sufficient or timeless cause; test energy, material, structure, circulation, scale and human mediation.

Qualified conclusion: Aeolian erosion and deposition interact with weathering, flash runoff, fan building, playa flooding and evaporation.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For a 10-mark answer, spend about one-sixth of the time decoding and drawing the map/flow; open with definition and thesis; organise three process-spatial points as claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification; compress examples before mechanisms and reserve the final minute for the causal limit.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains rather than catalogues, makes the spatial logic visible and avoids deterministic or timeless claims.

How to improve this answer: For “Explain how wind and episodic water jointly create arid landforms. Answer in about 150 words.”, replace the weakest generalisation with one labelled process arrow or map anchor and state the scale, exception or evidence needed before extending the conclusion.

ORIGINAL MAINS 3 - 15 MARKS

Question: Describe the Thar as a dynamic geomorphic and livelihood mosaic rather than a uniform sand sea. Answer in about 250 words.

Model thesis: Dunes, pediments, playas, drainage, ecological pulses and human adaptation create regional diversity.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- The Thar includes dune fields, interdunes, rocky residuals, pediments, alluvium, playas, settlements and canal-modified tracts; it is not one continuous erg.
- Highly variable rainfall, high evaporative demand, ephemeral drainage and pulse-based productivity support drought-adapted vegetation, pastoral mobility and risk-spreading livelihoods.
- The Thar is polygenetic: tectonic and drainage history, monsoon variability, wind reworking and human land use operated over different timescales; one-cause origin claims are unsafe.

Qualified conclusion: Dunes, pediments, playas, drainage, ecological pulses and human adaptation create regional diversity.

Demand decoding: The directive **describe** requires a direct position on “Describe the Thar as a dynamic geomorphic and livelihood mosaic rather than a uniform sand...”, all clauses and scales, a process chain, spatial reconstruction, named India/world evidence, a counter-condition and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Dunes, pediments, playas, drainage, ecological pulses and human adaptation create regional diversity.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** The Thar includes dune fields, interdunes, rocky residuals, pediments, alluvium, playas, settlements and canal-modified tracts; it is not one continuous erg. **Analysis:** Trace the driver -> mechanism -> spatial expression -> consequence chain and connect the named place, map or observation to the directive. **Qualification:** State the scale, threshold, interacting control, exception or source/date boundary.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Highly variable rainfall, high evaporative demand, ephemeral drainage and pulse-based productivity support drought-adapted vegetation, pastoral mobility and risk-spreading livelihoods. **Analysis:** Trace the driver -> mechanism -> spatial expression -> consequence chain and connect the named place, map or observation to the directive. **Qualification:** State the scale, threshold, interacting control, exception or source/date boundary.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** The Thar is polygenetic: tectonic and drainage history, monsoon variability, wind reworking and human land use operated over different timescales; one-cause origin claims are unsafe. **Analysis:** Trace the driver -> mechanism -> spatial expression -> consequence chain and connect the named place, map or observation to the directive. **Qualification:** State the scale, threshold, interacting control, exception or source/date boundary.

Counter-position / limit: A spatial association, one event, one model or one map layer does not establish a sufficient or timeless cause; test energy, material, structure, circulation, scale and human mediation.

Qualified conclusion: Dunes, pediments, playas, drainage, ecological pulses and human adaptation create regional diversity.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For a 15-mark answer, spend about one-sixth of the time decoding and drawing the map/flow; open with definition and thesis; organise five process-spatial points as claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification; compress examples before mechanisms and reserve the final minute for the causal limit.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains rather than catalogues, makes the spatial logic visible and avoids deterministic or timeless claims.

How to improve this answer: For “Describe the Thar as a dynamic geomorphic and livelihood mosaic rather than a uniform sand...”, replace the weakest generalisation with one labelled process arrow or map anchor and state the scale, exception or evidence needed before extending the conclusion.

ORIGINAL MAINS 4 - 15 MARKS

Question: Assess the role of the Aravalli and the Indira Gandhi Canal in shaping desertification risk. Answer in about 250 words.

Model thesis: Both alter spatial processes and livelihoods, but neither is a single-direction barrier or cure.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- The Aravalli influences relief, drainage, habitat connectivity and local erosion control, but it is not a complete wall that mechanically blocks all desert movement.
- Canal irrigation can support farming, water supply and settlement while seepage, waterlogging, salinity, invasive spread and crop-water mismatch create new risks where drainage is weak.

Qualified conclusion: Both alter spatial processes and livelihoods, but neither is a single-direction barrier or cure.

Demand decoding: The directive **assess** requires a direct position on “Assess the role of the Aravalli and the Indira Gandhi Canal in shaping desertification risk...”, all clauses and scales, a process chain, spatial reconstruction, named India/world evidence, a counter-condition and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Both alter spatial processes and livelihoods, but neither is a single-direction barrier or cure.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** The Aravalli influences relief, drainage, habitat connectivity and local erosion control, but it is not a complete wall that mechanically blocks all desert movement. **Analysis:** Trace the driver -> mechanism -> spatial expression -> consequence chain and connect the named place, map or observation to the directive. **Qualification:** State the scale, threshold, interacting control, exception or source/date boundary.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Canal irrigation can support farming, water supply and settlement while seepage, waterlogging, salinity, invasive spread and crop-water mismatch create new risks where drainage is weak. **Analysis:** Trace the driver -> mechanism -> spatial expression -> consequence chain and connect the named place, map or observation to the directive. **Qualification:** State the scale, threshold, interacting control, exception or source/date boundary.

Counter-position / limit: A spatial association, one event, one model or one map layer does not establish a sufficient or timeless cause; test energy, material, structure, circulation, scale and human mediation.

Qualified conclusion: Both alter spatial processes and livelihoods, but neither is a single-direction barrier or cure.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For a 15-mark answer, spend about one-sixth of the time decoding and drawing the map/flow; open with definition and thesis; organise five process-spatial points as claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification; compress examples before mechanisms and reserve the final minute for the causal limit.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains rather than catalogues, makes the spatial logic visible and avoids deterministic or timeless claims.

How to improve this answer: For “Assess the role of the Aravalli and the Indira Gandhi Canal in shaping desertification risk...”, replace the weakest generalisation with one labelled process arrow or map anchor and state the scale, exception or evidence needed before extending the conclusion.

ORIGINAL MAINS 5 - 20 MARKS

Question: Evaluate the drivers of Thar desertification and propose a process-matched restoration strategy. Answer in about 300 words.

Model thesis: Natural susceptibility becomes degradation when pressures exceed recovery; responses must target cover, soil, water, salinity and institutions.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Low and variable rainfall, erodible sediment, strong winds, saline basins and slow biological recovery create susceptibility without proving degradation.
- Vegetation removal, poorly managed grazing, repeated tillage, groundwater stress, mining, infrastructure fragmentation and unsuitable irrigation can exceed recovery thresholds.
- Dune stabilisation, shelterbelts, native grass and rangeland recovery, watershed treatment, drainage, salinity management and community institutions must match the diagnosed process.
- Land-cover change, vegetation productivity, soil carbon and field indicators need scale, baseline and causal interpretation; mapped degradation is not automatically current condition or programme impact.

Qualified conclusion: Natural susceptibility becomes degradation when pressures exceed recovery; responses must target cover, soil, water, salinity and institutions.

Demand decoding: The directive **evaluate** requires a direct position on “Evaluate the drivers of Thar desertification and propose a process-matched restoration...”, all clauses and scales, a process chain, spatial reconstruction, named India/world evidence, a counter-condition and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Natural susceptibility becomes degradation when pressures exceed recovery; responses must target cover, soil, water, salinity and institutions.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Low and variable rainfall, erodible sediment, strong winds, saline basins and slow biological recovery create susceptibility without proving degradation. **Analysis:** Trace the driver -> mechanism -> spatial expression -> consequence chain and connect the named place, map or observation to the directive. **Qualification:** State the scale, threshold, interacting control, exception or source/date boundary.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Vegetation removal, poorly managed grazing, repeated tillage, groundwater stress, mining, infrastructure fragmentation and unsuitable irrigation can exceed recovery thresholds. **Analysis:** Trace the driver -> mechanism -> spatial expression -> consequence chain and connect the named place, map or observation to the directive. **Qualification:** State the scale, threshold, interacting control, exception or source/date boundary.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** Dune stabilisation, shelterbelts, native grass and rangeland recovery, watershed treatment, drainage, salinity management and community institutions must match the diagnosed process. **Analysis:** Trace the driver -> mechanism -> spatial expression -> consequence chain and connect the named place, map or observation to the directive. **Qualification:** State the scale, threshold, interacting control, exception or source/date boundary.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** Land-cover change, vegetation productivity, soil carbon and field indicators need scale, baseline and causal interpretation; mapped degradation is not automatically current condition or programme impact. **Analysis:** Trace the driver -> mechanism -> spatial expression -> consequence chain and connect the named place, map or observation to the directive. **Qualification:** State the scale, threshold, interacting control, exception or source/date boundary.

Counter-position / limit: A spatial association, one event, one model or one map layer does not establish a sufficient or timeless cause; test energy, material, structure, circulation, scale and human mediation.

Qualified conclusion: Natural susceptibility becomes degradation when pressures exceed recovery; responses must target cover, soil, water, salinity and institutions.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For a 20-mark answer, spend about one-sixth of the time decoding and drawing the map/flow; open with definition and thesis; organise six to eight process-spatial points as claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification; compress examples before mechanisms and reserve the final minute for the causal limit.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains rather than catalogues, makes the spatial logic visible and avoids deterministic or timeless claims.

How to improve this answer: For "Evaluate the drivers of Thar desertification and propose a process-matched restoration...", replace the weakest generalisation with one labelled process arrow or map anchor and state the scale, exception or evidence needed before extending the conclusion.

ORIGINAL MAINS 6 - 20 MARKS

Question: Justify the proposition that desertification does not have simple climatic boundaries while retaining UNCCD precision. Answer in about 300 words.

Model thesis: Use broad degradation mechanisms across climates, then explicitly preserve the Convention's dryland definition.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- A desert is a climatic region, aridity a long-term moisture deficit, drought a temporary anomaly, land degradation a broad decline in condition, and desertification dryland degradation.
- The 2020 GS-I wording invites examples beyond visible deserts, but strict UNCCD usage confines desertification to arid, semi-arid and dry sub-humid lands; humid cases are broader land degradation.
- Land Degradation Neutrality seeks to balance anticipated losses with measures that avoid, reduce and reverse degradation while protecting land-based natural capital.
- SAC's Desertification Status Mapping Atlas is an official dated mapping baseline and UNCCD's 2026 material keeps restoration current; neither licenses an invented current Thar percentage or COP outcome.

Qualified conclusion: Use broad degradation mechanisms across climates, then explicitly preserve the Convention's dryland definition.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on “Justify the proposition that desertification does not have simple climatic boundaries while...”, all clauses and scales, a process chain, spatial reconstruction, named India/world evidence, a counter-condition and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Use broad degradation mechanisms across climates, then explicitly preserve the Convention's dryland definition.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** A desert is a climatic region, aridity a long-term moisture deficit, drought a temporary anomaly, land degradation a broad decline in condition, and desertification dryland degradation.
Analysis: Trace the driver -> mechanism -> spatial expression -> consequence chain and connect the named place, map or observation to the directive. **Qualification:** State the scale, threshold, interacting control, exception or source/date boundary.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** The 2020 GS-I wording invites examples beyond visible deserts, but strict UNCCD usage confines desertification to arid, semi-arid and dry sub-humid lands; humid cases are broader land degradation. **Analysis:** Trace the driver -> mechanism -> spatial expression -> consequence chain and connect the named place, map or observation to the directive. **Qualification:** State the scale, threshold, interacting control, exception or source/date boundary.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** Land Degradation Neutrality seeks to balance anticipated losses with measures that avoid, reduce and reverse degradation while protecting land-based natural capital. **Analysis:** Trace the driver -> mechanism -> spatial expression -> consequence chain and connect the named place, map or observation to the directive. **Qualification:** State the scale, threshold, interacting control, exception or source/date boundary.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** SAC's Desertification Status Mapping Atlas is an official dated mapping baseline and UNCCD's 2026 material keeps restoration current; neither licenses an invented current Thar percentage or COP outcome. **Analysis:** Trace the driver -> mechanism -> spatial expression -> consequence chain and connect the named place, map or observation to the directive. **Qualification:** State the scale, threshold, interacting control, exception or source/date boundary.

Counter-position / limit: A spatial association, one event, one model or one map layer does not establish a sufficient or timeless cause; test energy, material, structure, circulation, scale and human mediation.

Qualified conclusion: Use broad degradation mechanisms across climates, then explicitly preserve the Convention's dryland definition.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For a 20-mark answer, spend about one-sixth of the time decoding and drawing the map/flow; open with definition and thesis; organise six to eight process-spatial points as claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification; compress examples before mechanisms and reserve the final minute for the causal limit.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains rather than catalogues, makes the spatial logic visible and avoids deterministic or timeless claims.

How to improve this answer: For “Justify the proposition that desertification does not have simple climatic boundaries while...”, replace the weakest generalisation with one labelled process arrow or map anchor and state the scale, exception or evidence needed before extending the conclusion.